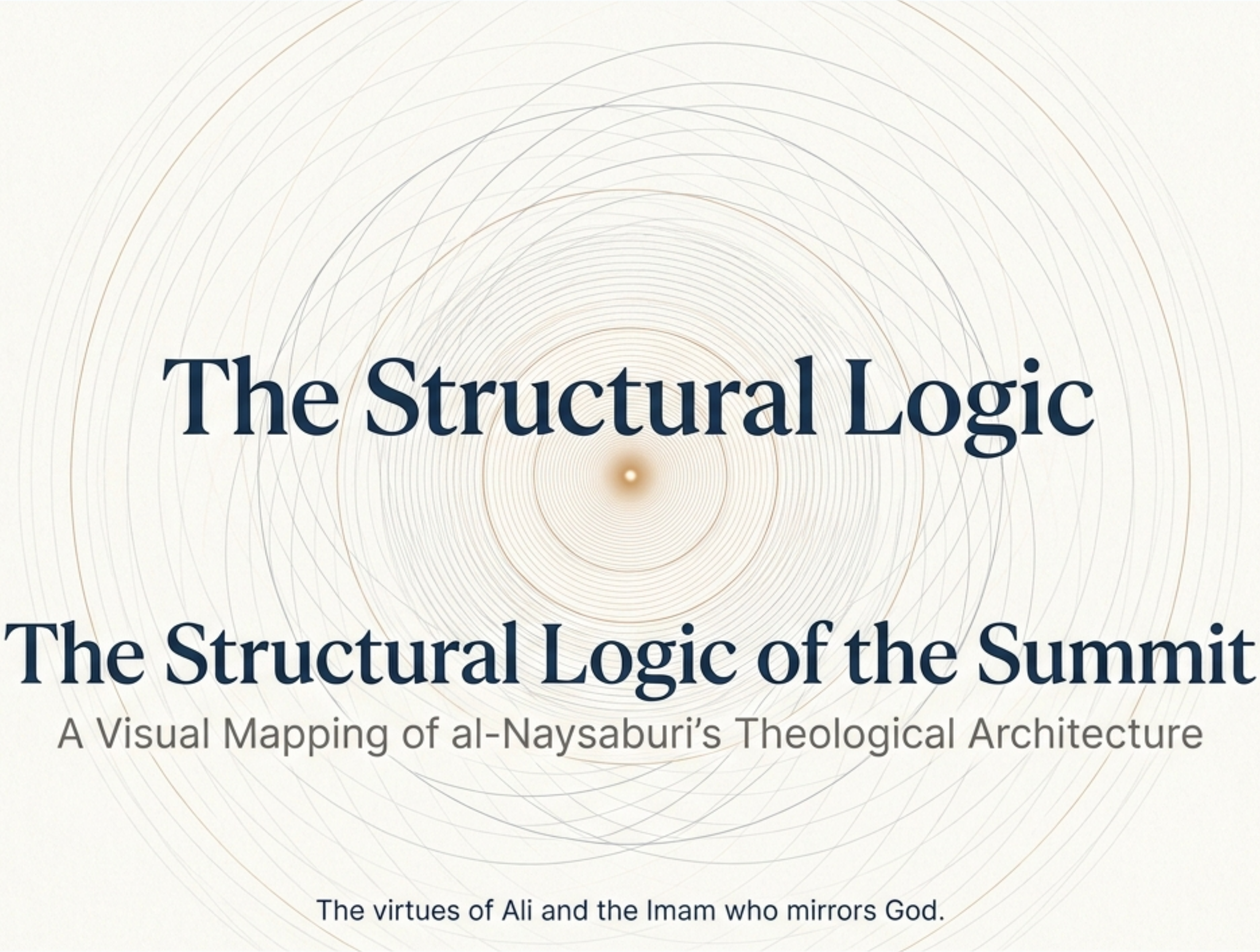




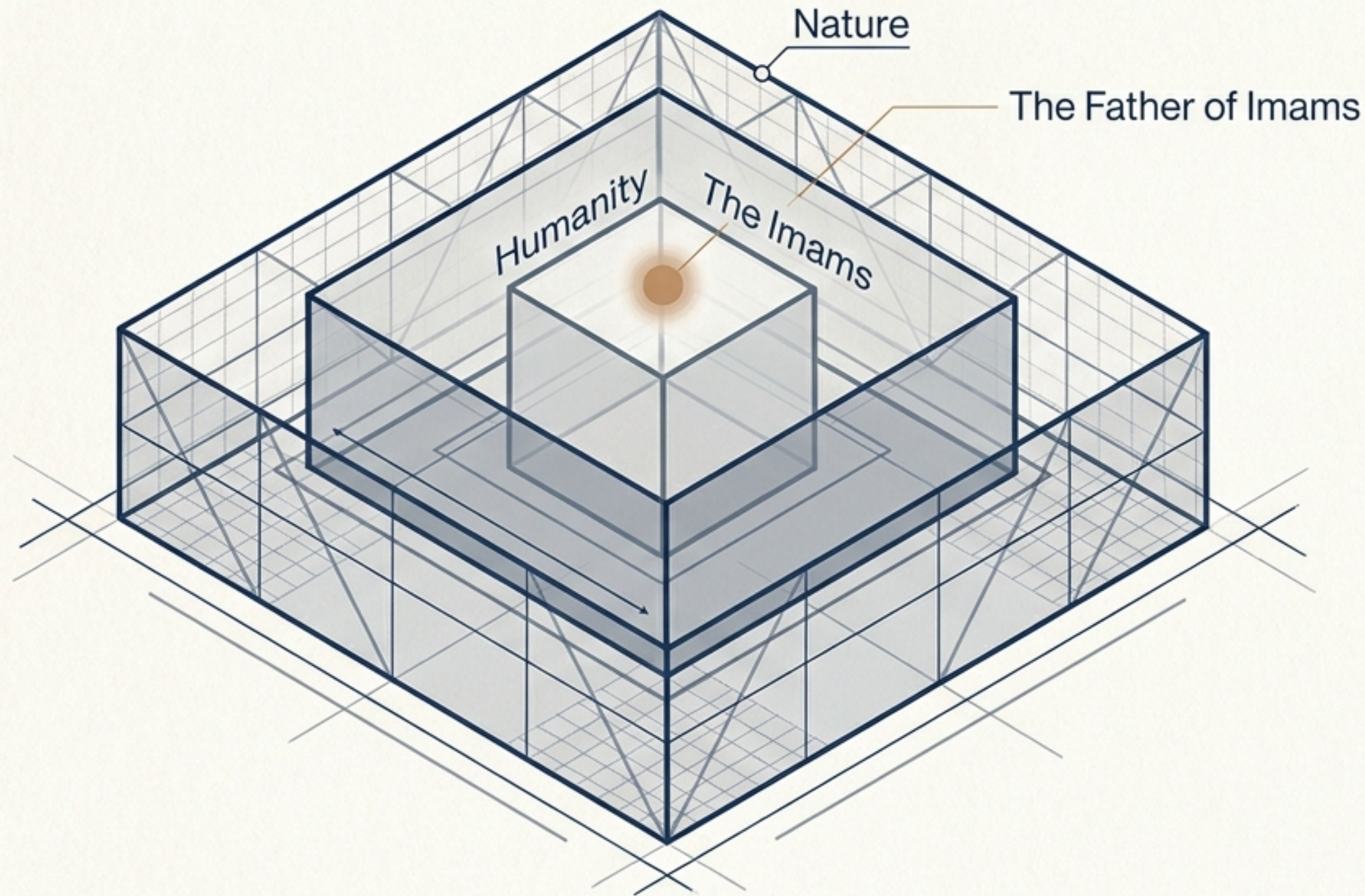
The Structural Logic

The Structural Logic of the Summit

A Visual Mapping of al-Naysaburi's Theological Architecture

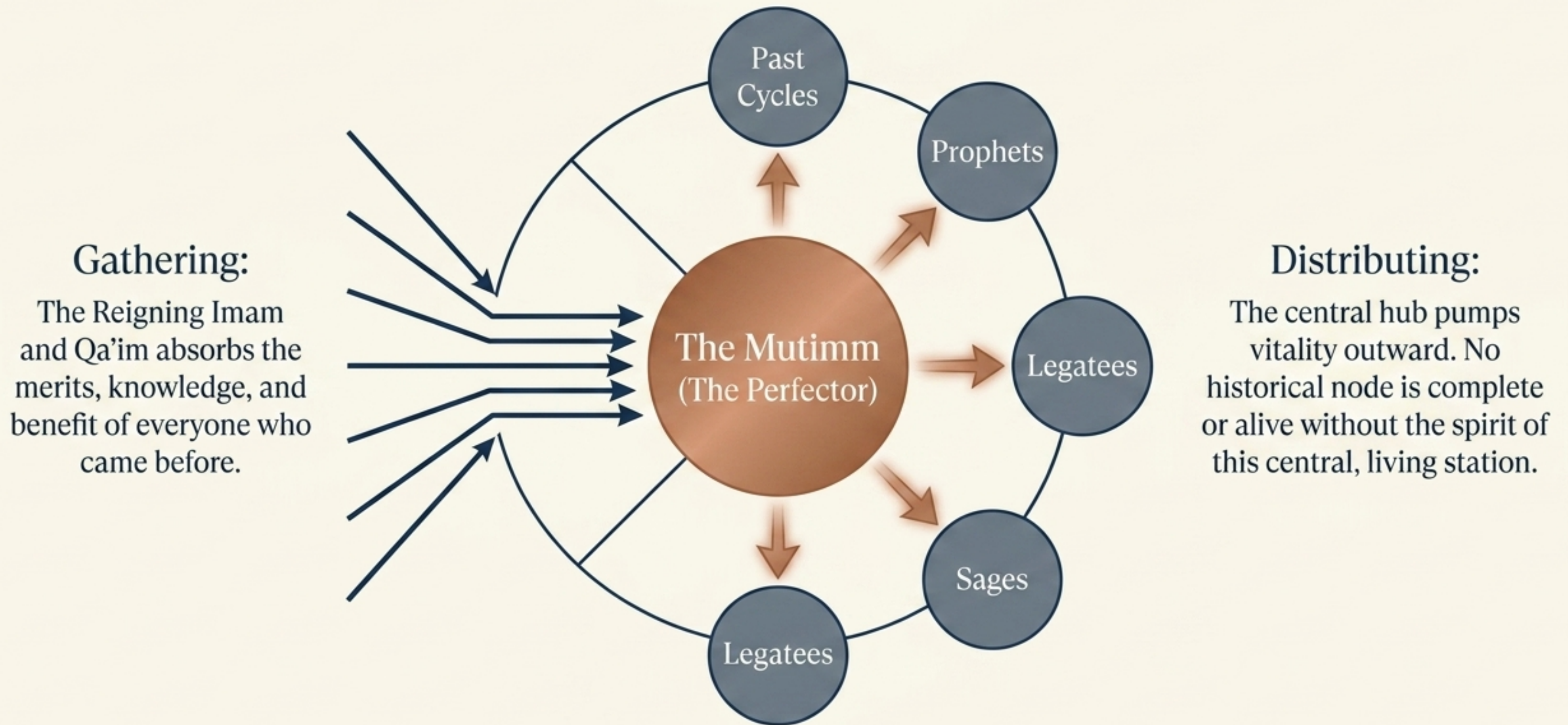
The virtues of Ali and the Imam who mirrors God.

The Convergence of Excellences

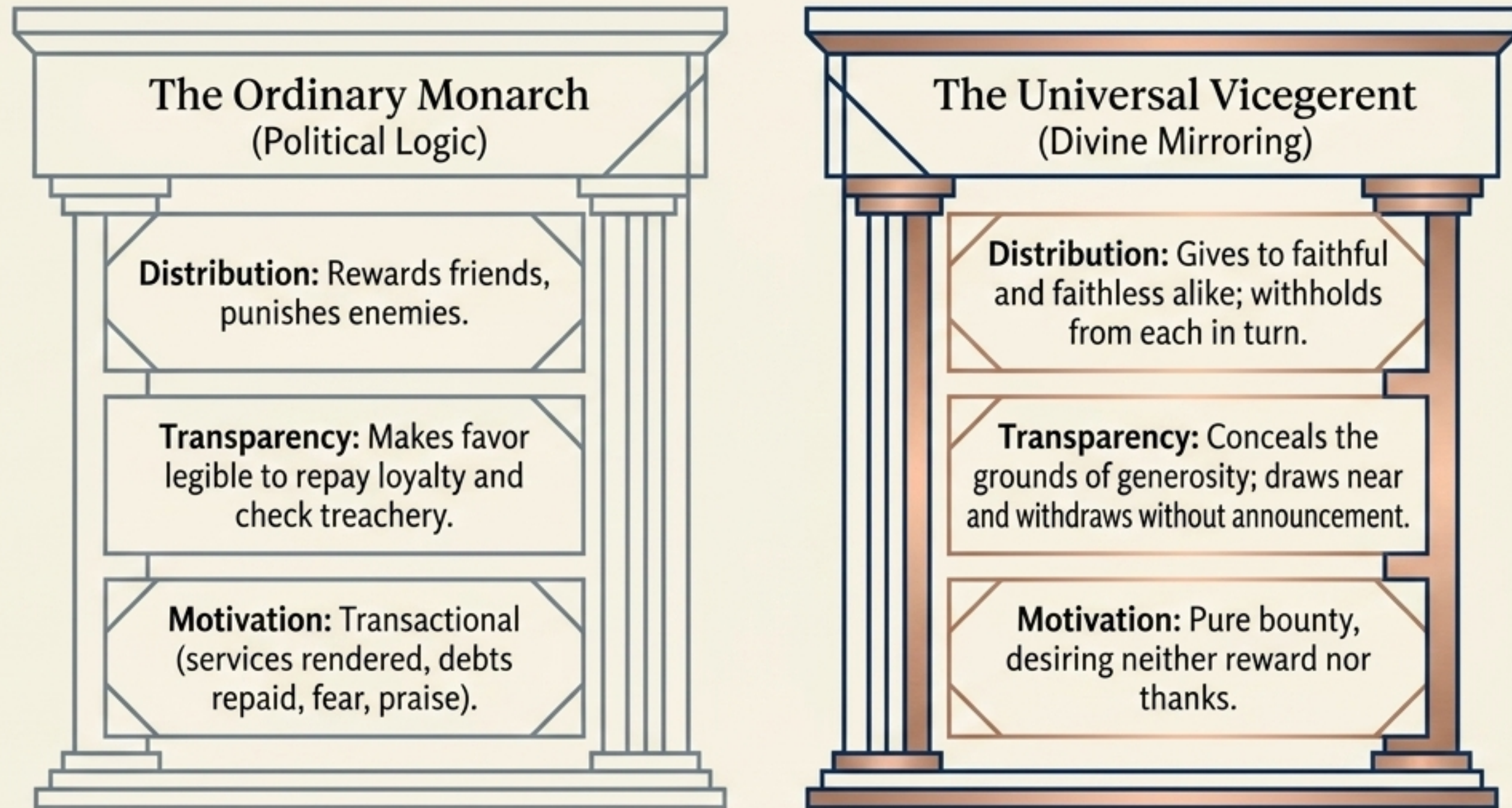


Nature does not spread its excellence evenly. It gathers excellence to a point. The entire hierarchy of peaks comes to rest at the ultimate limit beyond which there is no further limit.

The Mechanism of Gathering and Distribution



The Scandal of the Vicegerent



O David, We have made you a vicegerent on the earth, so judge between the people in truth (Chapter 38, Verse 26). To be a *khalifa* is to govern God's servants precisely as God governs them.

The Geometry of Provision

Human Type	Divine & Imam Action	The Underlying Wisdom
The Pious & Impious	Gives worldly benefit to both, withholds from both.	Prevents faith from becoming a business proposition; prevents unbelievers from collapsing into despair.
The Worshipper & Non-worshipper	Regards all with a merciful eye, not fixing on faults.	Ensures obedience is for God's sake, not merely to secure worldly return.
The Ignorant & The Learned	Treats every human type the same.	If only the learned profited, knowledge would be pursued purely as a road to wealth.

The Typology of Devotion



The Worship of Merchants

Driver: Desire for reward.

Nature: Angling for return, investment.



The Worship of Slaves

Driver: Fear of punishment.

Nature: Extracted, calculated, assessed.



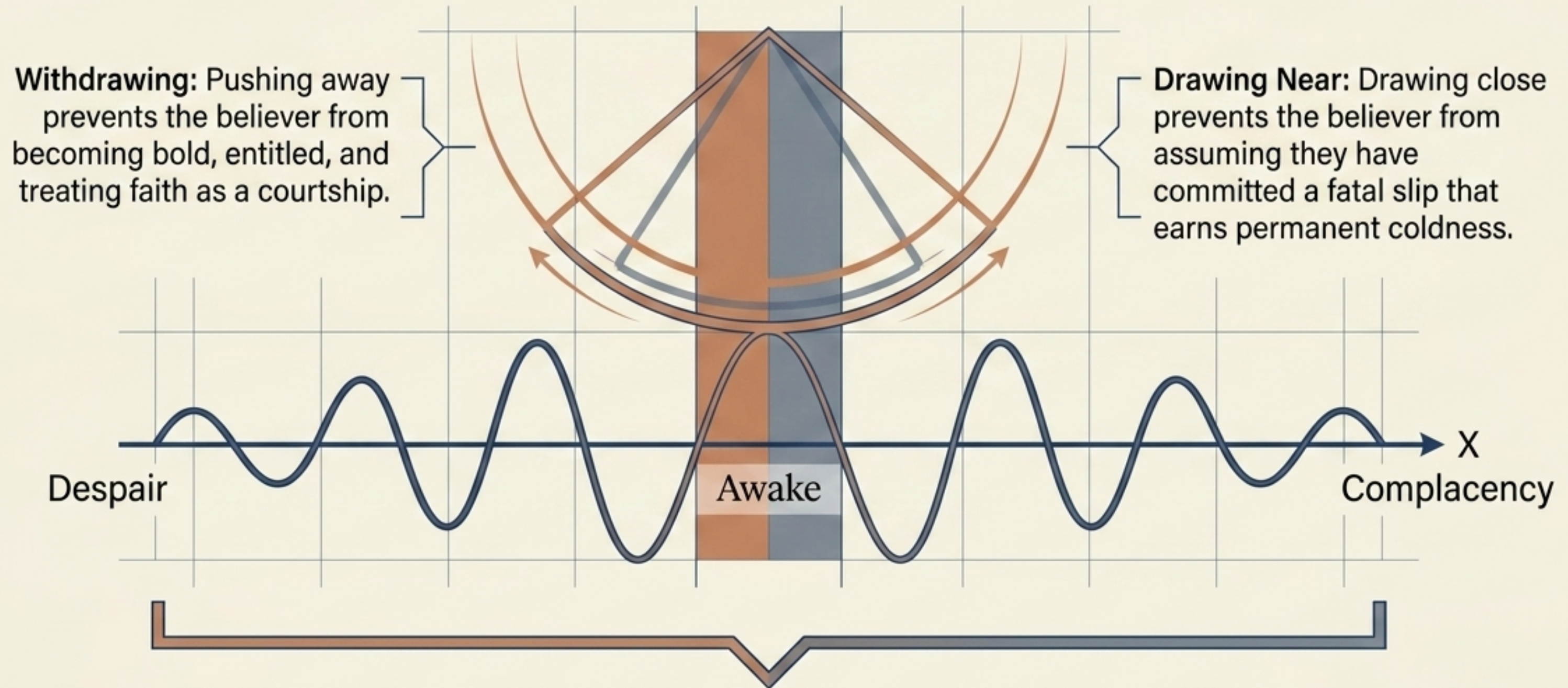
The Worship of the Free

Driver: Gratitude.

Nature: The open hand.
Owes nothing, asks nothing.
Moving only out of fullness.

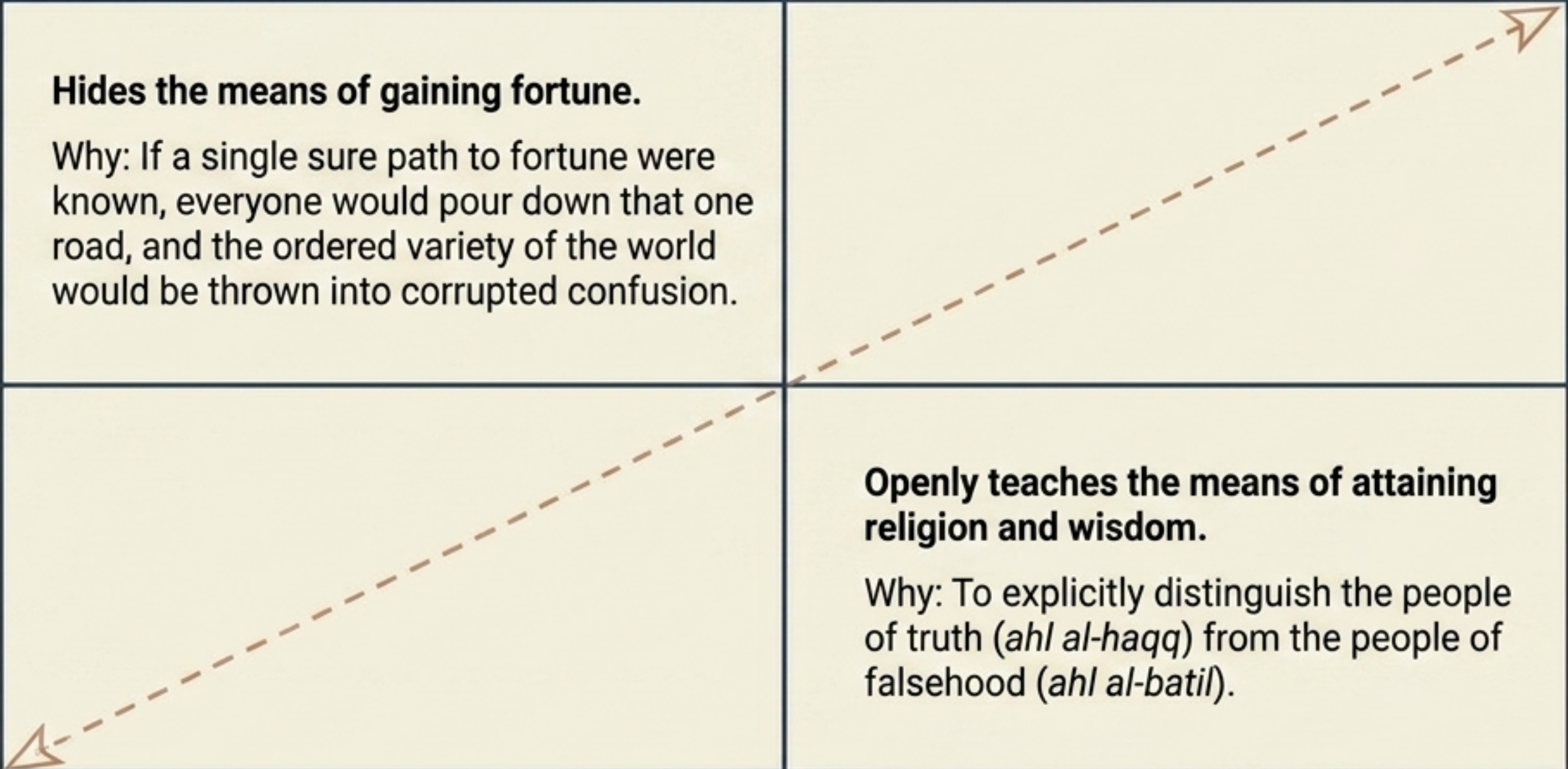
The Imam's giving is the giving of the free. It is the one giving in the human world that asks for nothing back.

The Suspension of the Soul

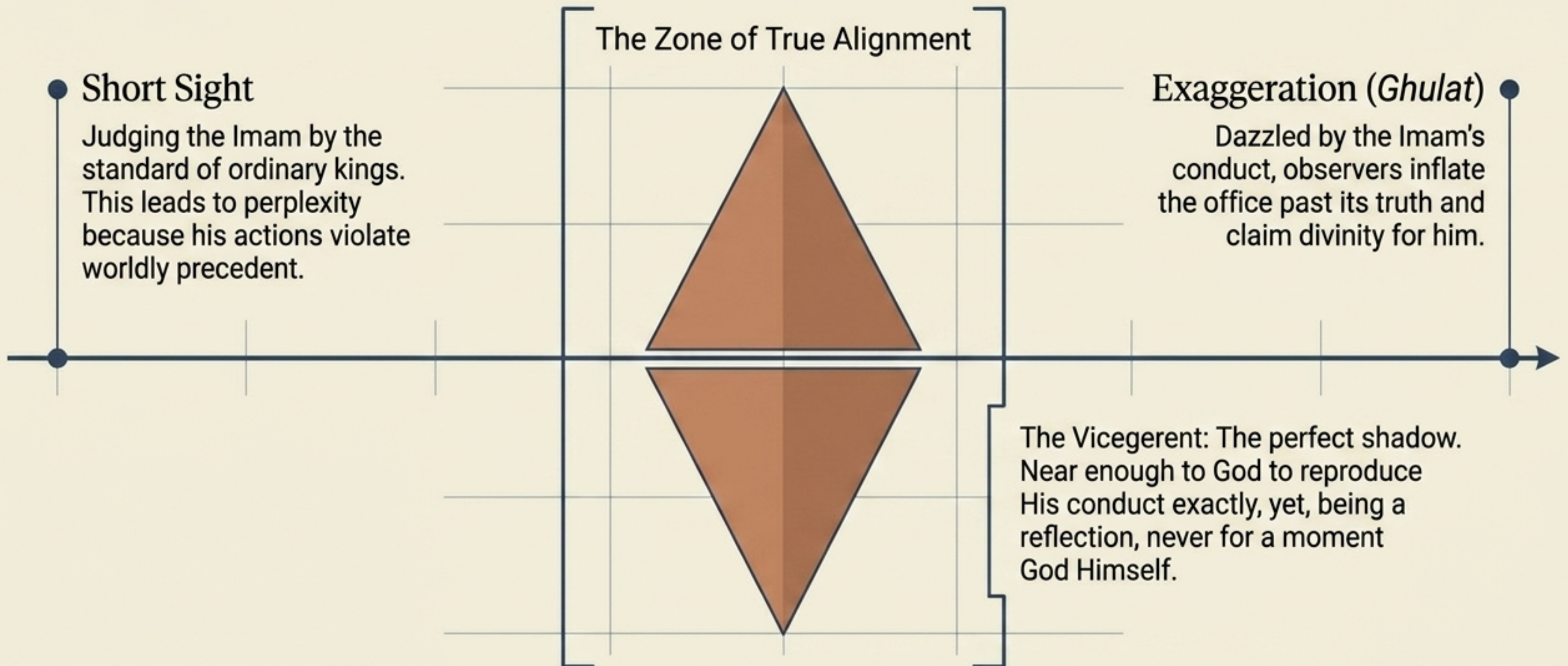


The soul remains perpetually suspended between fear and hope. This suspension is not neglect; it is the precise climate in which a soul stays awake.

The Architecture of Governance

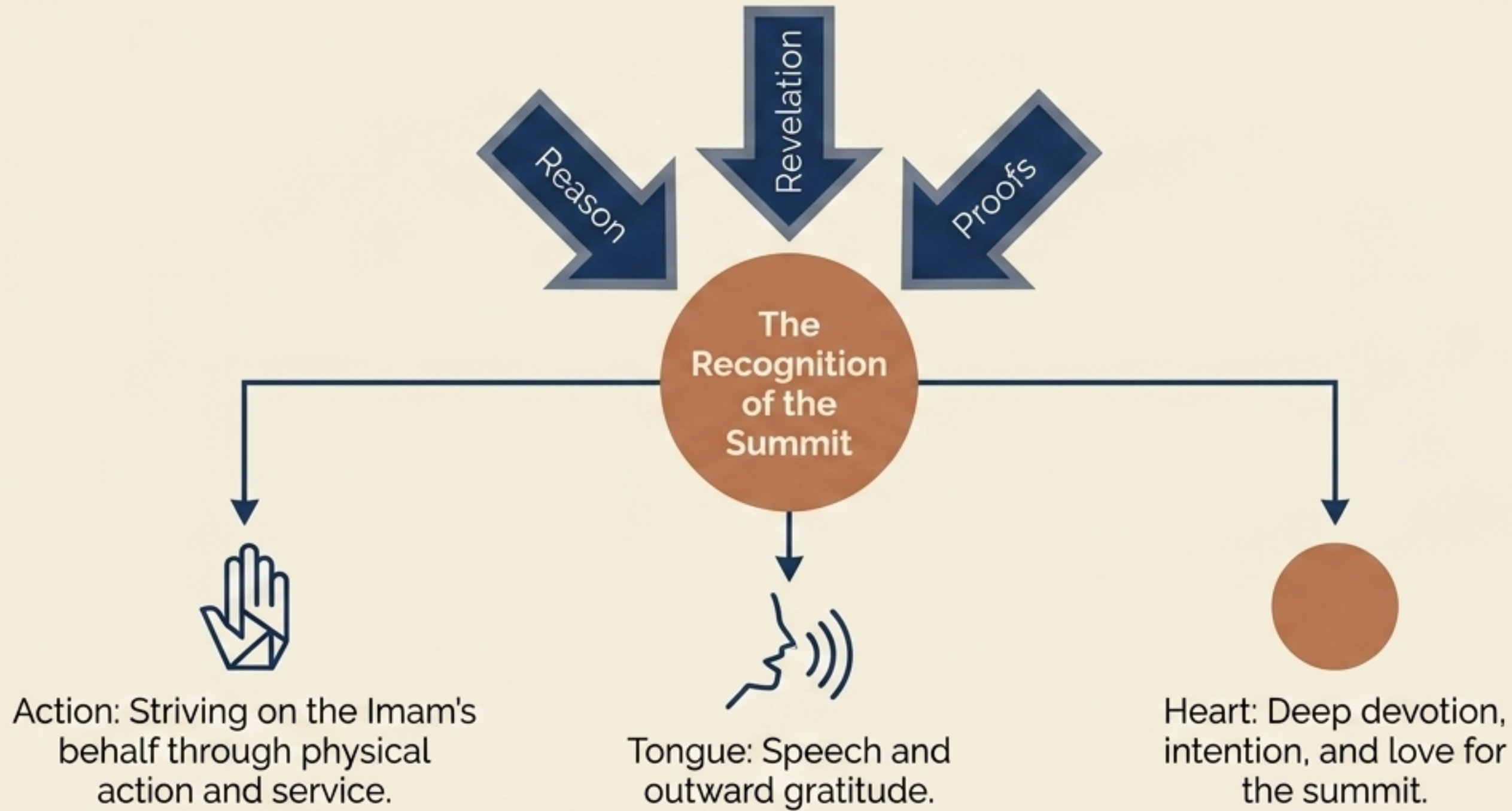
		Concealing	Disclosing
Worldly Matters	Hides the means of gaining fortune. Why: If a single sure path to fortune were known, everyone would pour down that one road, and the ordered variety of the world would be thrown into corrupted confusion.		
Religious Matters	Openly teaches the means of attaining religion and wisdom. Why: To explicitly distinguish the people of truth (<i>ahl al-haqq</i>) from the people of falsehood (<i>ahl al-batil</i>).		

The Margins of Epistemological Error



The Posture of the Soul

The argument was never the point in itself; it was the ladder.



The last note of the treatise is not the sound of a case being won, but the sound of a servant giving thanks for having been shown where to stand.